

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6
 ♥ 8 7 3
 ♦ Q J 10 4
 ♣ A 8 3 2

♠ Q 9 3
 ♥ A Q 10 2
 ♦ 7 5 3
 ♣ 7 5 4



♠ 7 4
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ K 9 6 2
 ♣ Q J 10 9

♠ A J 10 8 5 2
 ♥ K J 4
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ K 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ Q

play ♣s from his side of the table without handing you a trick. Whatever else he plays you win, pull trumps, and discard a ♣ loser on dummy's fourth ♥.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q. East plays the ♦ 9.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

On the plus side dummy has an extra ♥ winner on which you could discard a loser from your hand. The danger is that when you take the trump finesse, West might win the ♠ K and put his partner in the lead with the ♦ K for a ♣ play through your ♣ K.

To prevent that from happening all you have to do is hold up on the first ♦. You have to lose one trick in the suit no matter what, so lose it right now to West, the Safe Hand. West continues with another ♦ which you win.

You go over to dummy with a ♥ and play the ♠ Q, letting it ride. West wins with his ♠ K, but cannot

At notrump you usually hold up to exhaust one player of a suit so he cannot lead that suit back to his partner.

At suit contracts the most common reason for a hold-up is to keep the Danger Hand from getting the lead.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 3
 ♥ K Q 10 8 5
 ♦ K 10 9
 ♣ 7 2

♠ K Q 9

♥ A 3 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ Q 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 9 6

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 10 8 3

♠ A 8 4

♥ J 7 4

♦ Q 8 4

♣ A K J 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥K

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=4 Total = 8

Unless there is a miracle in the ♦s, (or a defensive error), you can't get a trick in that suit. But you have a chance for a second ♥ trick.

It's the Bath Coup again, just dressed up a little differently.

Let West hold the first trick, playing the ♥7 from your hand to conceal the ♥4 in the hope that West will continue the suit. If he does you have your ninth trick - if he doesn't, good luck.

Compare this Bath Coup to the one in Deal 10.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 8 7 2
 ♥ 10 7 5
 ♦ 10 9 4
 ♣ A 5

♠ A 6

♥ 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ Q J 10 9 4



♠ Q 4

♥ Q J 9 8

♦ J 8 6 2

♣ 8 7 2

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ A K 4

♦ A Q 7

♣ K 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 7

by leading his small x. If West can get in with the ♣ A he will run the ♠ s.

But what will East do if you play dummy's ♠ A? If he plays his small one the ♠ suit will block. If he unblocks his honor card then your ♠ 10 9 5 3 will provide a second stopper in the suit. So you go up with dummy's ♠ A and guarantee the contract.

A tough finish that needs some real visualization to get right.

Of course from now on you will recognize it.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=3 ♣=0 Total = 6

It's pretty clear that your extra tricks are going to have to come from the ♣ suit. The danger here is that West may have a 5-card ♠ suit that he can establish and the ♣ A as an entry. So what is the best approach, hold up or not hold up?

To answer that question you must think about West's lead. Since he did not lead the ♠ K you know he doesn't have a suit headed by K Q J. So you can visualize East sitting there with a doubleton honor in ♠ s. It might be ♠ K x, ♠ Q x or ♠ J x, but it is surely one of those three.

Think what East will do if you duck in dummy. He will play his honor, win the trick, and clear the suit